Stay Safe Online – Prevention Checklist

For College Students in India

🔐 General Digital Safety

#	Tip	Action
1	**Use strong, unique passwords**	Create passwords with at least 12 characters using a mix of letters, numbers, and symbols. Use a different password for every account. Consider using a password manager.
2	**Enable Two-Factor Authentication (2FA)**	Turn on 2FA for your email, social media, and banking apps. Even if someone steals your password, they cannot log in without the second factor.
3	**Keep your apps and operating system updated**	Software updates patch security vulnerabilities. Enable auto-updates on your phone and laptop.
4	**Avoid public Wi-Fi for sensitive activities**	Never log in to banking apps, UPI, or college portals over public Wi-Fi (cafés, buses, metro). Use your mobile data or a VPN instead.
5	**Do not click suspicious links in messages or emails**	If you receive a message from an unknown number or email with a link claiming you've won a prize, got a refund, or need to verify your account — do not click. Go directly to the official website instead.
6	**Check app permissions regularly**	Review which apps have access to your camera, microphone, contacts, and location. Revoke permissions that are not necessary.

💳 UPI & Financial Safety (Mandatory Tips)

| # | Tip | Action |

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| 7 | **Remember: Scanning a QR code to RECEIVE money is WRONG** | You never need to enter your UPI PIN or scan a code to receive a payment. If someone asks you to do this, it is a scam — you will be sending money, not receiving it. |

| 8 | **Never share your UPI PIN, OTP, or CVV with anyone** | No bank, UPI app, or customer care representative will ever ask for your PIN or OTP. If someone asks, hang up immediately and report the number. |

📱 Social Media & Identity Safety

| # | Tip | Action |

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| 9 | **Review your social media privacy settings** | Set your Instagram, Snapchat, and Facebook accounts to private. Limit who can see your posts, phone number, and location. |

| 10 | **Be cautious about what personal information you share online** | Avoid posting your home address, phone number, college schedule, or travel plans publicly. This information can be used for stalking or fraud. |

🚨 Reporting Cybercrime

If you or someone you know has been a victim of any cybercrime (fraud, harassment, identity theft, etc.):

| Channel | Details |

|---------|---------|

| **National Cyber Crime Reporting Portal** | cybercrime.gov.in – File a complaint online, 24×7 |

| **Cyber Crime Helpline** | **1930** – National helpline, available 24×7 |

| **Local Police Station** | Visit the nearest police station to file an FIR if needed |

| **Bank / UPI App** | Report UPI fraud immediately to your bank via their helpline to initiate a chargeback request |

> 💡 **Remember:** Cybercriminals rely on speed and panic. If something feels wrong, stop, breathe, and verify before acting. It is always better to lose a "deal" than to lose your money.

This checklist was created as part of the Digital Literacy Portfolio (CSE0001), VIT Bhopal University.